

STERLING MCKINLEY

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Summary

Engineer with experience in building resilient, scalable, and automated infrastructure. Skilled in designing cloud-native platforms, improving system reliability through observability and performance engineering, and driving operational excellence with automation, CI/CD, and Infrastructure as Code. Adept at bridging development and operations to deliver secure, high-availability systems that support rapid product delivery and long-term platform stability.

Skills

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS EC2, VPC, S3, RDS, Infrastructure as Code Terraform, Ansible

Site Reliability: Root Cause Analysis, Error Budgets, SLI/SLO/SLA, MTTA/MTTD/MTTR, Disaster Recovery

Monitoring/Observability: Datadog, New Relic, Dynatrace, Prometheus, Grafana, AWS CloudWatch, Observe

Containers & Orchestration: Kubernetes, EKS, ECS, Docker

CI/CD & Version Control: GitHub, GitHub Actions, GitLab, Jenkins, Bitbucket, IBM UrbanCode Deploy

Operating Systems & Middleware: Linux RHEL, Ubuntu), Windows Server IIS, AIX, Solaris, Tomcat, JBoss, WebSphere

Programming Languages & Scripting: Python, Bash scripting

Automation/AI: GitHub Copilot, Anthropic Claude, Google Gemini, Windsurf

Tools: Visual Studio, Confluence, Jira, PagerDuty, ServiceNow, G-Suite, Microsoft Teams, Slack, Zoom, Postman

Certifications

[AWS Certified AI Practitioner AIF-C01 - Amazon Web Services](#)

[Reliability Engineering: Measuring and Managing Reliability](#)

[Google AI Essentials – Google](#)

[KCNA: Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate - The Linux Foundation](#)

[AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner - Amazon Web Services](#)

Education

Eastern Illinois University

Bachelor of Science in Management Information Systems

Charleston, Illinois

Kura Labs

DevOps Engineer/Site Reliability Engineering – Apprenticeship

Virtual

07/2022 - 12/2022

Experience

Capital One

Chicago, Illinois

Platform Engineer / Site Reliability Engineer

01/2023 - Present

- Primary technical liaison between the IFX line of business and the Chief of Staff, leading and aligning engineering velocity with executive strategic priorities and project roadmaps.
- Managed an enterprise portfolio of 500 applications within the Intelligent Foundations & Experiences IFX line of business, driving cloud-native resiliency, operational readiness, continuous compliance, and strict vulnerability remediation.
- Championed blameless post-mortems, incident management, and systematic troubleshooting protocols across New Relic, Observe, and CloudWatch, slashing service interruptions and critical incidents by 20%
- Spearheaded SLO/SLI definition across critical AWS services for core applications; engineered multi-window burn-rate alerting to proactively manage Error Budgets, driving a 93% SLO attainment and a 30% reduction in critical incidents.
- Engineered, provisioned, and optimized scalable AWS cloud infrastructure EC2, ECS/EKS, Lambda, RDS, utilizing Infrastructure as Code IaC to enable rapid, repeatable production deployments.
- Formulated self-service workflows that eliminated CI/CD pipeline bottlenecks, accelerated developer productivity, and mitigated deployment-related service disruptions.
- Integrated AI/ML engineering tools (GitHub Copilot, Windsurf, Gemini) to automate retrieving performance metrics, recurring support tasks, and construct internal tooling, significantly boosting team operational velocity.
- Identify points of failure in operational efficiency and streamline a new workflow to strengthen the customer's experience.

PNC

Remote

Infrastructure Configuration Consultant

07/2019 - 01/2023

- Managed 24/7/365 production operations, serving as the tier-3 escalation point for overnight and on-call incidents across critical enterprise banking infrastructure.
- Engineered and optimized enterprise middleware platforms, sustaining high-performance deployments of OpenShift containerized environments, WebSphere, and JBoss across RHEL and Windows Server ecosystems.
- Spearheaded root cause analysis RCA by analyzing application heap dumps and system metrics, implementing permanent architectural and configuration fixes that reduced production incidents by 20%.
- Diagnosed and resolved deployment pipeline failures across IBM UrbanCode Deploy and Bitbucket environments, optimizing pipeline performance and minimizing software delivery cycle times.
- Monitored applications and systems to track performance, proactive troubleshooting, and automate system management to prevent disruptions.

Peraton (formerly Perspecta) - Application Integrator

07/2018 - 07/2019

- Served as primary technical support resource for Federal Reserve Bank of New York - Auction Reporting (TAAPS) application
- Installed, managed, and monitored applications hosted on IBM WebSphere Application Server NDv8.5.5.x & IBM HTTP v8.5.5.x platform
- Integrated several software products and/or systems into the Auction Reporting application/environment

Hyatt - Operations Analyst

11/2017 - 07/2018

- SaaS (Software as a Service)
- First point of contact for Hyatt's global World of Hyatt LMS - Loyalty Management System-related inquiries regarding operational processes and issues.
- Provided support for third-party vendor software, LMS code deployments, and maintenance releases, and functioned as team liaison working with hotel locations, application development teams, corporations, partnerships, and external vendors to triage LMS issues
- Created and maintained documentation for solution requirements, use cases, user acceptance criteria, and training material

Hansen Technologies (formerly Sigma Systems) - Technical Account Manager

03/2017 - 11/2017

- SaaS (Software as a Service)
- Served as primary technical contact for the client in Caribbean markets (Miami, Barbados, Bahamas, Jamaica, Trinidad, St. Lucia, St. Vincent, Grenada, India)
- Managed and supported Sigma Systems' proprietary software
- Installed, configured, administered, and supported Java applications/systems hosted on Unix/Linux operating systems utilizing middleware technology (Oracle WebLogic Server and Red Hat JBoss)
- Debug Java applications in production environments, including stack traces, logs, and exception analysis
- Monitored applications and systems to track performance, proactive troubleshooting, and automate system management to prevent disruptions.

- On call Support (1st shift & 3rd shift)
- Installed and configured IBM WebSphere Application Server in vertical and horizontal clustered environments
- Migrated applications hosted on WebSphere version 6.x to WebSphere version 8.5.x and WebSphere version 7.x to WebSphere version 8.5
- Tasked with deployments, administration, configuration, upgrades, maintenance, and troubleshooting of J2EE applications in WAS, JAR & EAR formats on WebSphere Application Server, in multi-clustered, high-availability environments
- Defined and configured application servers, JVMs, Virtual Hosts, Web Applications, Web Resources, Servlets, MQ, JDBC providers, and data sources connecting to various databases, including SQL, DB2, and mainframe
- Debug Java applications in production environments, including stack traces, logs, and exception analysis
- Monitored applications and systems to track performance, proactive troubleshooting, and automate system management to prevent disruptions.